Warm-up / A club speaks for everyone?

Keep the conclusion within the evidence

Name: _____ Date: _____

Suggested lesson time: 20 minutes. Work individually, then compare when invited.

Useful words

Conclusion: The statement an argument asks us to accept on the basis of its reasons.

Sample: The people or cases actually studied.

Representative sample: A group selected to reflect the wider population relevant to the question.

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: Nine of ten chess-club members asked say they want a lunchtime tournament. The club leader says, 'Every student in our school wants one.' No students outside the club were asked.

Produce: Write one sentence identifying the jump and one narrower conclusion.

Your steps

1. Name the group asked and the group covered by the leader's conclusion.

2. Write a conclusion that keeps both the surveyed group and the nine-of-ten result.

Before you finish: Does your rewrite avoid both “all club members” and “all students”?

Your response

Main activity / The grading-rubric survey

Name: _____

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: Eighteen of 24 students in one art class say they prefer a new grading rubric. The other six say they do not prefer it. The principal announces, 'Every student in our 600-student school prefers it.' No other students were asked.

Produce: Write a scope comparison, a supported conclusion, and one further evidence need.

Your steps

1. Complete: 'The evidence covers ___, but the conclusion covers ___.'

2. Rewrite the conclusion as one sentence that the survey actually supports.

3. Name one additional kind of evidence needed before estimating school-wide preferences.

Before you finish: Does your rewrite retain the art-class sample and the six students who did not prefer the rubric?

Your response

Exit ticket / A survey of park volunteers

Name: _____

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: A town has 2,000 residents. Twelve of 15 residents at a park clean-up say they favor Sunday street closures. The mayor says, 'Most town residents favor the closures.' No other residents were asked.

Produce: Write three sentences: the gap, a supported conclusion, and a better evidence plan.

Your steps

1. Compare the residents actually asked with those covered by the mayor's conclusion.
2. Rewrite the result without extending it beyond those surveyed.
3. Describe who a new survey should include to estimate town-wide support.

Before you finish: Have you noticed that even a claim about “most” can reach beyond an unrepresentative sample?

Your response